



PARISHRAM 2027

KEEPING QUIET

Lecture -6 Class 12

By Anurag Tyagi Sir



Topics to be Covered

1 Warm-up Game

2 Prose : Keeping Quiet

3 Exercise and Quiz



GAME TIME!





GUESS THE IDIOM



Look at the pictures and guess the idiom!

1



Guess the idiom:



2



Guess the idiom:



3



Guess the idiom:





GUESS THE IDIOM



Here are the answers!

1



Idiom: **A piece of cake**

Meaning: Something that is very easy to do.

2



Idiom: **Break the ice**

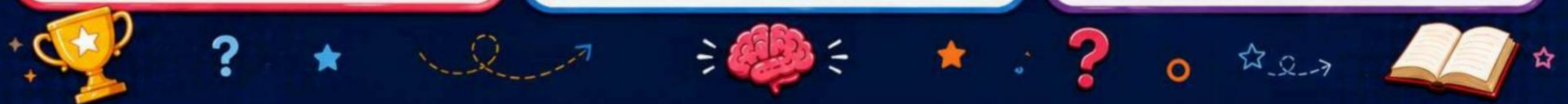
Meaning: To start a conversation in a social situation and make people feel more comfortable.

3



Idiom: **Bite off more than you can chew**

Meaning: To take on a task that is too big or difficult to handle.



Question 1



Harry's appointment to this important post was a feather in his cap.

- A)** False pride
- B)** Vanity
- C)** Additional income
- ✓ D)** A new achievement

Question 2



She's got the gift of the gab she could probably sell ice to Eskimos.

- ☒ A) Have the talent to speak well
- ☐ B) Achieve sudden greatness
- ☐ C) Have the ability to adapt
- ☐ D) Receive a precious gift

A serene landscape illustration featuring a calm lake reflecting a golden sunset. In the foreground, a large tree with green leaves frames the left side, and purple flowers grow on the grassy bank. The background shows rolling green hills, evergreen trees, and majestic mountains under a sky with soft, pinkish clouds. The overall mood is peaceful and contemplative.

KEEPING QUIET

—  —

PABLO NERUDA

Introduction

The poem "**Keeping Quiet**" by Pablo Neruda is a thoughtful reflection on the need for silence, self-introspection, peace, and harmony among human beings.

Neruda does not ask people to stop living or working forever. Instead, he urges us to pause for a brief moment, think about our actions, and build a more peaceful and compassionate world.

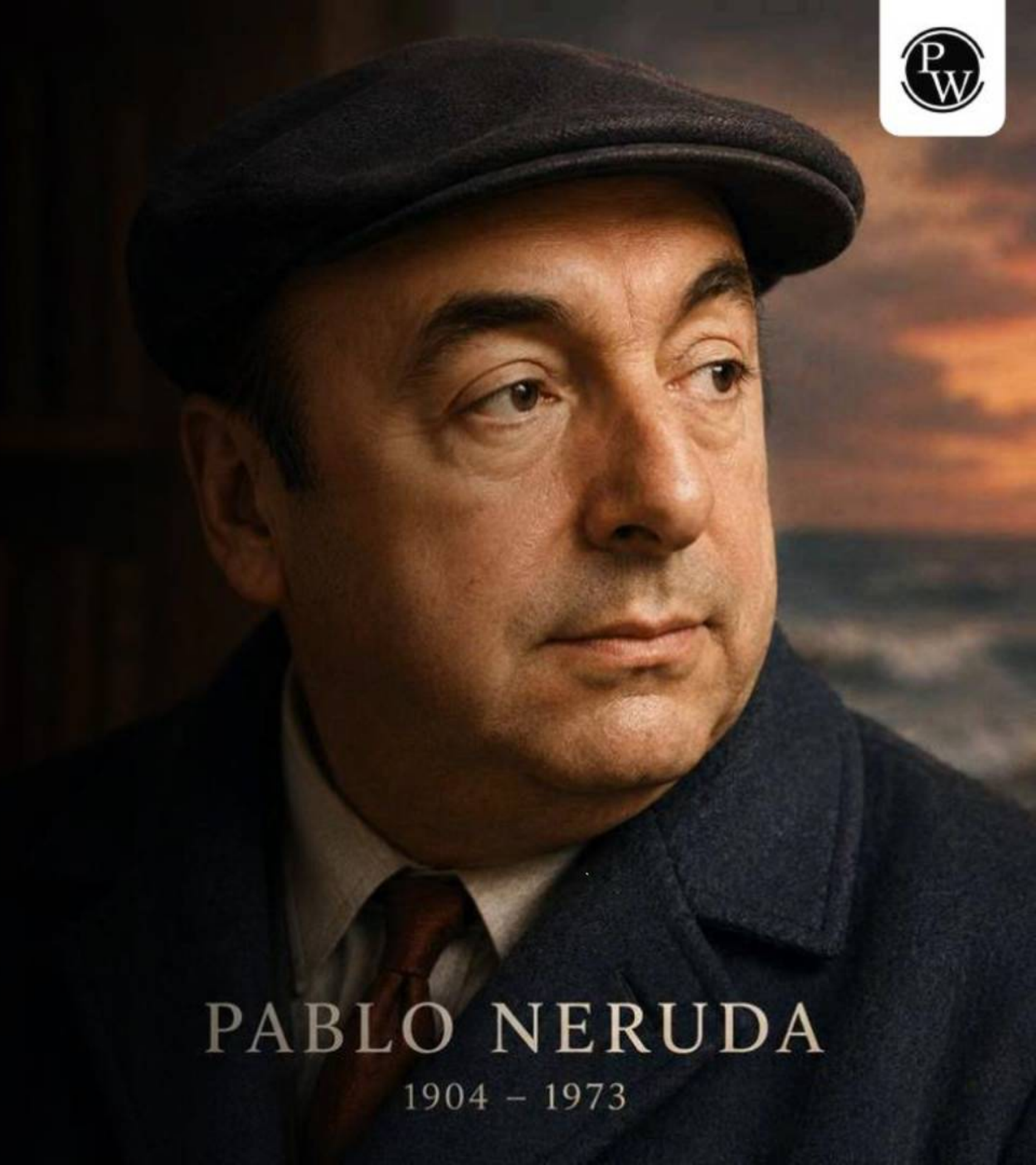
Poet



- The real name of Pablo Neruda (1904-1973) was Neftali Ricardo Reyes Basoalto.
- Born on July 12, 1904, in Parral, Chile, Neruda spent his early childhood in Temuco and began contributing some articles in a daily at the age of 13.

PABLO NERUDA

1904 – 1973



Poet

- In 1920, he adopted the pen name Pablo Neruda in the memory of Czechoslovak poet Jan Neruda and made literary contributions to the journal Selva Austral.
- Neruda was conferred the Nobel Prize for Literature in the year 1971.

PABLO NERUDA

1904 – 1973



Complete cycle (12 hours,
12 months)

Now we will count to twelve

momentary pause

and we will all keep still.

motionless, शून्य

For once on the face of the Earth

the whole world

let's not speak in any language,

let's stop for one second,

stop our actions

and not move our arms so much.



unusual; rare अनोखा
It would be an exotic moment
hurry
without rush, without engines,
united
we would all be together
अजीब
in a sudden strangeness.
immediate



Fishermen in the cold sea
would not harm whales
and the man gathering salt
injured
would look at his hurt hands.



War against environment

Those who prepare green wars,

Conventional wars/ weapons
wars with gas, wars with fire,

victory with no survivors,
remaining people

to wear fresh perspective
would put on clean clothes

and walk about with their

fellow human beings
brothers

old
in the shade, doing nothing.



What I want should not be

Confused

with total inactivity. *Complete idleness; life without a purpose*

Life is what it is about. → *life is meant to be lived.*

I want no touch with death.
association

If we were not so *focused* single-minded about keeping our lives moving, and for once could do nothing, perhaps a huge silence might *stop* interrupt this sadness of never understanding ourselves and of threatening ourselves with death.

Self-harming human behaviour



Perhaps the Earth can teach us
as when everything seems dead
and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve
and you keep quiet and I will go. //



Message

- ① Silent self-introspection is important
- ② Unity, brotherhood, harmony
- ③ We should learn from nature
- ④ Trust the powers!

A group of diverse people, including adults and children, are sitting in a circle on a grassy field at sunset. The scene is dimly lit, with the warm glow of the setting sun in the background. The text 'MCQ' is overlaid in the center.

MCQ

Q. What does the poem speak about?

- A) The necessity to be happy
- ✓ B) The necessity to introspect, understand and have feelings of brotherhood
- C) The necessity to work quietly
- D) None of the above



Q. What does the poem 'Keeping Quiet' teach us?

- A) How to maintain silence
- B) Not to make noise
- C) Speaking creates noise
- ✓ D) To be peaceful, thoughtful and have feelings of brotherhood

Q. What is the rhyme scheme used in the poem?

- A) Enclosed rhyme
- B) Monorhyme
- C) Sonnet
- ✓ D) Free verse



Q. How is keeping quite related to life and can change attitude?

- A) It helps to think and search soul
- B) Helps to scratch one's soul
- C) Helps to develop new thinking process
- ☒ D) All of these

Q. What does the **earth** symbolise?

- ☒ **A)** Perseverance and new beginning from seemingly stillness
- ☐ **B)** Stillness
- ☐ **C)** Greenery
- ☐ **D)** Prosperity

Q. What is the poet expecting from fishermen?

- A) To find more fish
- B) To go deeper into the sea
- ☒ C) To think and stop harming the fish
- D) None of the above

Q. While gathering salt, what will happen to the man if he keeps silent for a moment?

- A) He will stop dropping it
- B) He will look at the ground
- C) He will walk carefully
- ✓ D) He will think of the harm the salt is doing to his hands

Q. In 'Keeping Quiet' the poet does not want the reader to confuse his advice for _____ with total inactivity. (CBSE SQP 2022 Term I)

- A) Experimentation
- B) Relaxation
- C) Isolation
- ✓ D) Introspection

Q. Identify the tone of Pablo Neruda in the following line.

Perhaps the Earth can teach us _____.

- A) Confident and clear about the future events.
- B) Dramatic about the prediction he made.
- C) Convinced about the sequence of events to follow.
- ☒ D) Uncertain, yet hopeful about the possibility.

Q. What statement does Neruda make about wars?

(CBSE Question Bank 2021)

- A) Wars are of varied kinds - internal, green wars, wars with gas, with fire etc.
- B) Wars are useful and yield a lot of profit of property and life.
- ☒ C) Wars never yield any winners, and the loss is far greater than what can be measured.
- D) Wars are unavoidable in the enduring struggle for human dignity and power.

A group of diverse children sitting in a circle on a grassy field at sunset, with mountains in the background. The scene is dimly lit, with the warm glow of the setting sun creating a serene atmosphere. The children are looking towards the center of the circle, suggesting a communal activity or storytime.

Poetic Devices!

Now we will count to twelve
and we will all keep still.

For once on the face of the Earth
let's not speak in any language,
let's stop for one second,
and not move our arms so much.

It would be an exotic moment
without rush, without engines,
we would all be together
in a sudden strangeness.

Fishermen in the cold sea
would not harm whales
and the man gathering salt
would look at his hurt hands.

Those who prepare green wars,
wars with gas, wars with fire,
victory with no survivors,
would put on clean clothes
and walk about with their
brothers
in the shade, doing nothing.

What I want should not be
confused
with total inactivity.
Life is what it is about;
I want no truck with death.
If we were not so single-minded
about keeping our lives moving,
and for once could do nothing,
perhaps a huge silence

might interrupt this sadness
of never understanding ourselves
and of threatening ourselves with
death.

Perhaps the Earth can teach us
as when everything seems dead
and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve
and you keep quiet and I will go.

Alliteration



Now we will count to twelve
and we will all keep still.

For once on the face of the Earth
let's not speak in any language,
let's stop for one second,
and not move our arms so much.

It would be an exotic moment
without rush, without engines,
we would all be together
in a sudden strangeness.

Fishermen in the cold sea
would not harm whales
and the man gathering salt
would look at his hurt hands.

Those who prepare green wars,
wars with gas, wars with fire,
victory with no survivors,
would put on clean clothes
and walk about with their
brothers
in the shade, doing nothing.

What I want should not be
confused
with total inactivity.
Life is what it is about;
I want no truck with death.
If we were not so single-minded
about keeping our lives moving,
and for once could do nothing,
perhaps a huge silence

might interrupt this sadness
of never understanding ourselves
and of threatening ourselves with
death.

Perhaps the Earth can teach us
as when everything seems dead
and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve
and you keep quiet and I will go.

Symbolism

Now we will count to twelve
and we will all keep still.

Anaphora

For once on the face of the Earth
let's not speak in any language,
let's stop for one second,
and not move our arms so much.

It would be an exotic moment
without rush, without engines,
we would all be together *Repetition*
in a sudden strangeness.

Fishermen in the cold sea
would not harm whales
and the man gathering salt
would look at his hurt hands.

Those who prepare green wars,
wars with gas, wars with fire,
victory with no survivors,
would put on clean clothes
and walk about with their
brothers
in the shade, doing nothing.

What I want should not be
confused
with total inactivity.
Life is what it is about;
I want no truck with death.
If we were not so single-minded
about keeping our lives moving,
and for once could do nothing,
perhaps a huge silence

might interrupt this sadness
of never understanding ourselves
and of threatening ourselves with
death.

Perhaps the Earth can teach us
as when everything seems dead
and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve
and you keep quiet and I will go.

Now we will count to twelve
and we will all keep still.

For once on the face of the Earth
let's not speak in any language,
let's stop for one second,
and not move our arms so much.

It would be an exotic moment
without rush, without engines,
we would all be together
in a sudden strangeness.

Fishermen in the cold sea
would not harm whales
and the man gathering salt
would look at his hurt hands.

Those who prepare green wars,
wars with gas, wars with fire,
victory with no survivors,
would put on clean clothes
and walk about with their
brothers

in the shade, doing nothing.

Enjambment

What I want should not be
confused
with total inactivity.
Life is what it is about;
I want no truck with death.
If we were not so single-minded
about keeping our lives moving,
and for once could do nothing,
perhaps a huge silence

might interrupt this sadness
of never understanding ourselves
and of threatening ourselves with
death.

Personification

Perhaps the **Earth can teach us**
as when everything seems dead
and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve
and you keep quiet and I will go.

Summary

The poem begins on a note of quiet introspection. The poet asks the readers to count to twelve and then sit still. He urges them not to speak any language and for some time not involve themselves in any movement. The poet believes that this moment of extreme silence and stillness will be an exotic one with no rush of life and no noise of the engines. In this moment of silence one can experience the strength of togetherness; a sudden, strange relationship to which humanity binds itself. In this blissful moment of extreme silence, the fishermen would be inactive and not harm the whales and even the man gathering the salt will get some time off from his hectic schedule to look at his hands and reflect at the pain and damage his tiring task has caused him.

When everyone on the earth thinks of keeping quiet for some time and does not involve oneself in any activity, that moment will be bliss. People who are engaged all the time in the exploitation of Nature or are preparing themselves for chemical wars (which will not leave behind any survivors) shall find time to wear clean clothes and walk around with their fellowmen strengthening the message of peace and brotherhood.

The poet cautions that his thoughts regarding quietness and stillness should not be confused with total inactivity. Life certainly is an ongoing dynamic process and should not be associated with death. But he sincerely feels that if at least once we do not focus our minds on keeping our lives mobile and spend some time in deep silence doing nothing, we can rid ourselves of the sadness of isolation. In that hour of introspection, we will find time to understand ourselves better and escape from the threatening calls of death.

The poet feels that the Earth teaches us how everything comes to an end and then comes back to life again. In the same manner, from this hour of silence, introspection and inactivity one can learn the need to bring all evil thoughts to their end and to revive a new life of peace. The poet brings an end to this session of introspection instructing men to keep quiet and then leaves them in deep tranquility.

‘If speech is silver, silence is golden’, for in the vast treasure of deep silence one can find a large resource of peace and tranquility. In the hidden recesses of silence, all diversions disappear because one is at one’s peaceful best at that point of time. Silence creates an exotic moment, where one forgets every type of segregation; wars come to a standstill and a feeling of brotherhood prevails. The poem “Keeping Quiet” celebrates the necessity of following the adage “Live and Let live”. Much of the evil shall disappear in the depths of an understanding, silent and inactive life. Life on earth can become a heaven for those moments when man does nothing for a while.

Glossary

- **Exotic** – Exciting
- **To have no truck with** – to refuse to have any association with something
- **Interrupt** – Obstruct

A background image showing a group of children sitting in a circle on the grass, looking towards the center. The scene is dimly lit, suggesting dusk or dawn, with mountains visible in the background.

NCERT QnA

Questions



- ✓ Q. What will counting up to twelve and keeping still help us achieve?
- ✓ Q. Do you think the poet advocates total inactivity and death? ✨
- ✓ Q. What is the 'sadness' that the poet refers to in the poem?
- ✓ Q. What symbol from Nature does the poet invoke to say that there can be life under apparent stillness? ★★★★★★

Seeming

Q. What will counting up to twelve and keeping still help us achieve?

(Foreign 2009; Delhi 2015)

Ans:

Counting up to twelve and keeping still will help us put a brake on the rush and humdrum of life. It will also help us to introspect, reflect and experience silence and peace. In such a moment we can find solution to all our problems and difficulties.

Q. Do you think the poet advocates total inactivity and death?

(Delhi 2011)

Ans:

No, the poet does not advocate total inactivity. Admitting life to be an ongoing process, he wants man's activities to be positively channelised. In fact, he wants that man should put an end to his hostile and destructive activities and promote constructive activities. He does not want to have any truck with death by being its agent in any way.

Q. What symbol from Nature does the poet invoke to say that there can be life under apparent stillness?

(Delhi 2015)

Ans:

The poet wants to invoke the symbol of automatic self-regeneration from Nature. This symbol teaches the human beings to be inspired by throbbing life that remains unnoticed under the cover of decay. Human beings can thus learn that life and death go hand in hand, so one should focus on life without worrying about death.



PYQs

Q. 'There is life under apparent stillness'. Explain.

(CBSE 2023)

Q. What, according to Pablo Neruda in the poem 'Keeping Quiet', is the lesson that we should learn from mother earth?

(CBSE 2023)

OR

According to the poet, what is it that human beings can learn from nature?

(All India 2010)

Q. What does Neruda mean by 'an exotic moment without rush' in his poem, 'Keeping Quiet'?

(CBSE SQP 2021)

Q. How will 'Keeping Quiet' protect our environment?

(CBSE 2020, 2015)

Q. 'There is life under apparent stillness'. Explain.

(CBSE 2023)

Ans:

The given phrase means that even when everything seems inactive and almost still, there is some activity in the background that shows that everything is alive. In other words, 'stillness' is not death but a time wherein activity happens in the background to promote positive development.

Q. What, according to Pablo Neruda in the poem 'Keeping Quiet', is the lesson that we should learn from mother earth? (CBSE 2023)

OR

Q. According to the poet, what is it that human beings can learn from nature? (All India 2010)

Ans:

According to Pablo Neruda in the poem 'Keeping Quiet', the lesson that we should learn from mother earth is to remember that there is activity and positivity in the apparent stillness. He states that just like a seed that remains in a latent state but soon germinates into a plant, we can also learn many things during the moment of silence and retrospection.

Q. What does Neruda mean by 'an exotic moment without rush' in his poem, 'Keeping Quiet'?

(CBSE SQP 2021)

Ans:

By the phrase 'an exotic moment without rush' Neruda refers to the moment of silence and stillness when everything will be at peace. There will no movement, chaos, miscommunications, fights and so on.

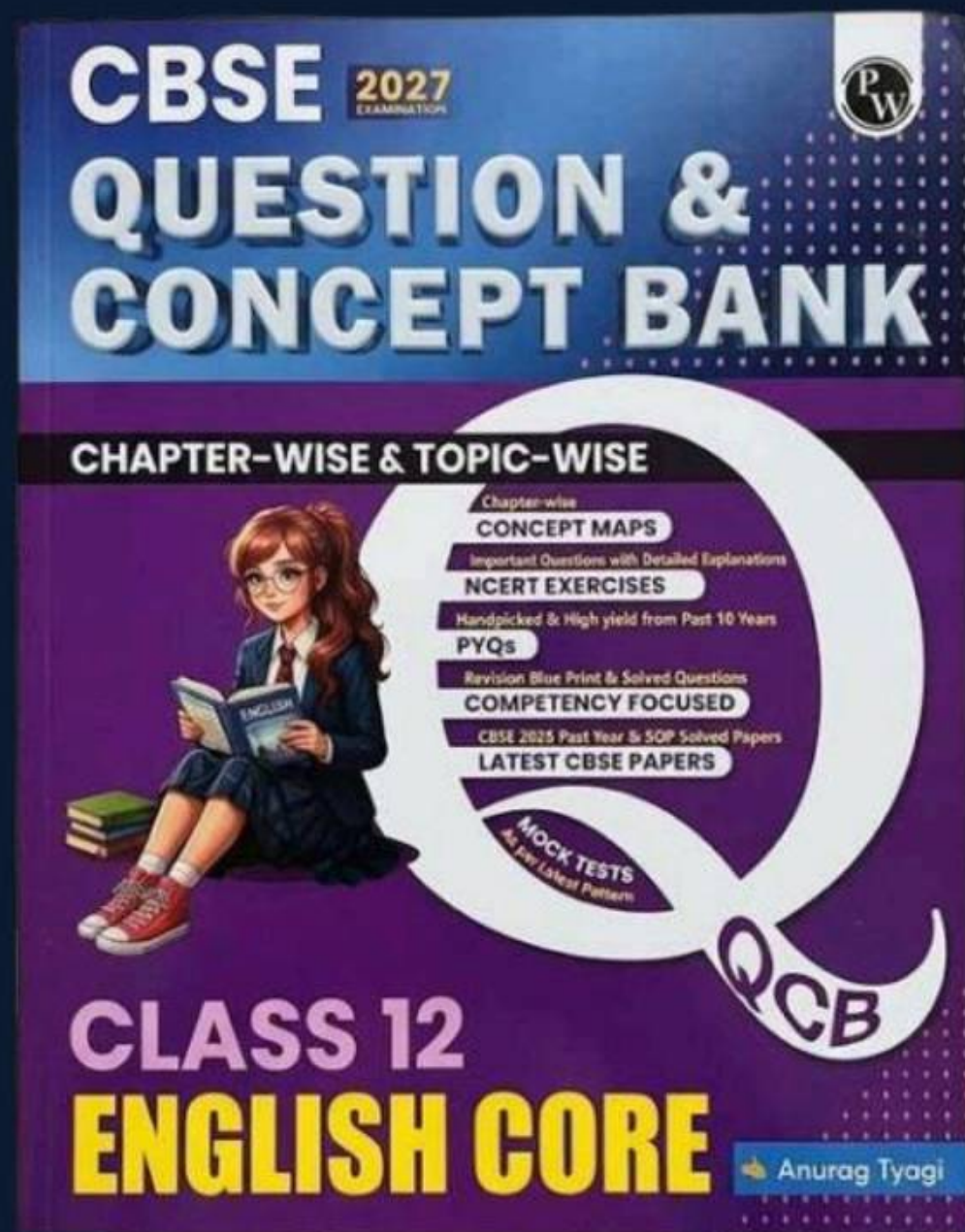
Q. How will 'Keeping Quiet' protect our environment?

(CBSE SQP 2021)

Ans:

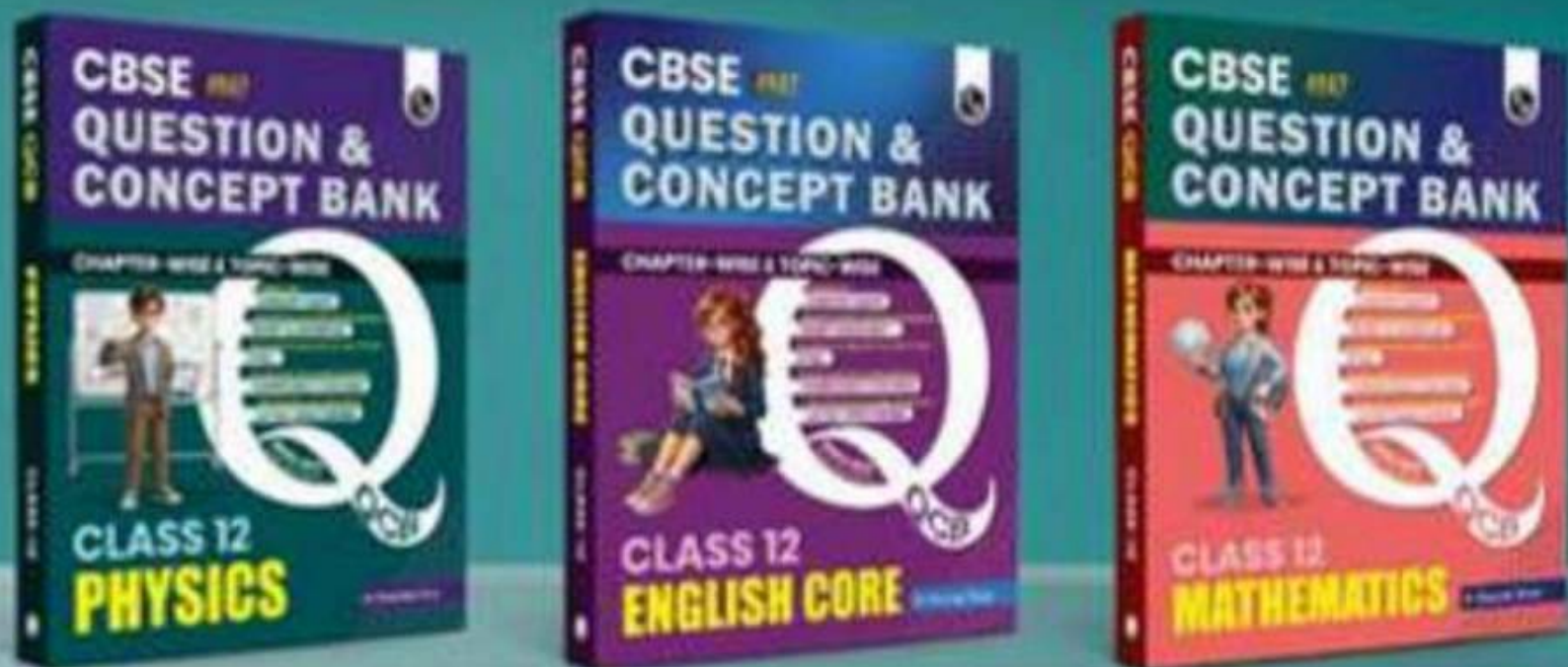
Keeping quiet and introspecting will initiate peace and brotherhood among men, halting all destructive activities like waging wars which harm people besides damaging the environment. Thus, the environment will be protected.

English Sample Question Paper



WHERE QUESTIONS LEAD YOUR PREPARATION FOLLOWS

Complete Practice for **Boards 2026**



-  Chapter-wise Concept Maps
-  NCERT & Exemplar Questions
-  Handpicked PYQs (Past 10 Years)
-  Competency-Based Questions
-  Latest CBSE Sample Papers
-  Mock Tests (Latest Pattern)



CLASS 12th Science CBSE (TEST SERIES)

Physics Wallah

Class 12th - Science - CBSE Board

Dr. Anshu Malik

Study

Library

Test Series

My Test

Scholarship

PG Store

PG Books

PG Library

PG Labs

PG Mocking

PG Store & Cart

Test Series

Online Test Pass [12th CBSE]

- ✓ NCERT Mastery Test Series
Detailed solution of Back Exercises
- ✓ PYQ PowerPack
Last 5 Years' solved Papers
- ✓ Preparation Booster
Track Progress with Term exams

Explore 8 more Benefits

₹1,000 ~~₹1,000~~
50% OFF

Buy Now

Online + Offline Test Pass [12th CBSE]

- ✓ Pre-Boards Test Series
Board pattern practice tests
- ✓ NCERT Mastery Test Series
Detailed solution of Back Exercises
- ✓ PYQ PowerPack
Last 5 Years' solved Papers

Explore 8 more Benefits

₹1,700 ~~₹1,000~~
50% OFF

Buy Now

With our new PG Courses Online + Offline Pass

Common Benefits


Real Exam Pattern & Difficulty


Bookmarks for Smarter Prep


Smart Performance Analysis


Multi-Language Facility



Physics World

Class Title: Science - CBSE Board



Features and Offerings:

 Chapter Wise Tests Targeted topic to Score Full	 Preparation Booster Term exam Preparation
 Micro-Learning Units Quick & Smart Study	 Weekly HOTS Assessment Regular Weekly Quiz
 NCERT Mastery Series NCERT Solved Back Exercises	 All Subjects Modules Maths, Science, SST & Languages

Smart Performance Analysis (The Report Card)

Stop Guessing. Know your Weak Areas instantly

- ➡ **Instant Error Log:** See exact step-by-step solutions for every wrong answer.
- ➡ **Time Management Tracker:** Check if you are spending too long on single questions.
- ➡ **Accuracy Metrics:** Learn if your mistakes are conceptual errors or silly calculation slips.
- ➡ **Peer Benchmarking:** See your live rank among classmates to drive healthy competition.

A diverse group of people of various ages and ethnicities are sitting in a circle on a grassy field at sunset. They appear to be meditating or practicing mindfulness. In the background, there are mountains and a body of water under a warm, orange-hued sky. The text 'Thank you!' is overlaid in the center in a large, white, serif font.

Thank you!